

the device (DPI *versus* pMDI) by GPs and specialists.

GPs (N = 2757)		OR [95% CI]
Gender	Female	1.00
	Male	0.96 [0.81–1.13]
Age	<18 years	1.00
	18–65 years	1.35 [0.88–2.07]
	>65 years	1.40 [0.87–2.25]
Comorbidities	No comorbidities	1.00
	1 co-morbidity	1.05 [0.86–1.28]
	At least 2 co-morbidities	0.96 [0.76–1.21]
BMI		1.02 [1.01–1.04]*
Medication	Fluticasone/salmeterol	1.00
	Beclometasone dipropionate/formoterol	0.19 [0.16–0.23]*
<i>Specialists (N = 289)</i>		OR [95% CI]
Gender	Female	1.00
	Male	1.19 [0.69–2.06]
Age	<18 years	1.00
	18–65 years	4.64 [1.64–13.13]*
	>65 years	11.01 [2.38–50.88]*
Comorbidities	No comorbidities	1.00
	1 comorbidity	0.95 [0.48–1.89]
	At least two comorbidities	0.65 [0.04–9.64]
PEF		1.01 [0.99–1.03]
Smoking	No	1.00
	Yes	1.40 [0.75–2.58]
Medication	Fluticasone/salmeterol	1.00
	Beclometasone dipropionate/formoterol	0.17 [0.08–0.37]*

*, p-value < 0.05.

BMI: body mass index; DPI: dry powder inhaler; GP: general practitioner; PEF: peak expiratory flow; pMDI: pressurised, metered-dose inhaler; OR: Odds Ratio; CI: confidence interval.